

Rep. Tom Emmer on Twin Cities News Talk

KTLK

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HOST (JOHN):

Representative Tom Emmer, good morning. How are we doing this morning, sir?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I mean, personally, I'm doing great. Yeah, I as a member of Congress, not so great. Yeah, we'll get we'll get to get into that in just just a moment.

JOHN:

I do want to talk about in a second, Trump and his moves yesterday that at least prompted the Democrats to agree to fund TSA. Before we do that, though, I want to ask you, I know the congressional hockey game was last night. How did that go? Did you wake up sore this morning?

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, no, I feel pretty good for, you know, a guy who was off the ice for many, many months for the first time in a long time in my life. And it actually was a lot of fun, a lot of fun. Raised money for Wounded Warriors. This is a partnership with the NHL Congress, the Congressional Hockey Caucus and the NHL. We raised money for Fort DuPont, Inner City Youth Sports. The Wounded Warriors and through the NHL Foundation for Women's Hockey in Minnesota. I'm sorry, Michigan and Massachusetts. So I all in all, it was great. The game, believe it or not, I was a three three tie. It was tied up. We tied it up with about a minute and a half left in the third period. Went through a five minute overtime, still no score. And then sadly, we lost in a shot. So what a great game, though. A lot of fun had by all.

JOHN:

Well, President Donald Trump yesterday kind of called the Democrats bluff and they folded, at least partially late in the day. For those that didn't hear the opening of the show in the first hour, you can check it on the check it out on the iHeartRadio app on the podcast. But Trump had said that he was going to take some DHS funding and give it over to TSA to get the TSA workers back to work. You know, hopefully, you know, removing ice from the equation. And I think that the expectation from Trump, at least this is my speculation, Tom Emmer, is that, you know, he was thinking that, all right, I'll put the Democrats in a tough spot if they want to challenge me on this. They can. We'll see whether or not that's a good or bad look for him. But into the late hours last night, there was some partial funding to go to TSA in the wake of President Donald Trump's move. So a step forward, but not a step forward enough, Representative Tom Emmer.

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, I mean, these guys are cowards. I got to tell you, first off, the president, what he did was he declared a national emergency and he started having immigration and customs enforcement officers and others showing

up at our airports and actually assisting TSA. This whole thing is a ridiculous exercise, and it's all because of the Democrats' radical base. I mean, do you realize, John, the Department of Homeland Security has been in a government shutdown for roughly half of the fiscal year because of these guys. They don't care about American security in this fight that they just generated. I think you're probably right about the president's other motive, which is, OK, go ahead and stop me. I'm going to take care of the American people. I'm going to try and solve the problem that you have created with this ridiculous situation where TSA, you've got some lines are five hours or more. People have to get there the night before. And it's just totally unacceptable that the TSA, Coast Guard and FEMA are all not getting paid because of the Democrats' refusal to do the responsible thing by funding the government. So what happens, though, is these guys, I mean, all the fight, they are such cowards. It passed on a voice vote, unanimous consent at 3 a.m. this morning with literally no one in the Senate chamber. I mean, and these guys all take off now today for their little two week away from Washington vacation and figure that they've got their job done. You know, it's going to be interesting. We're going to look at the details today. I we what's sad, John, is the House passed a bipartisan funding bill three separate times. This is a bill that was agreed to by the House, by the Senate, by Republicans and Democrats. And then all of a sudden, the radical base of Democrats which Chuck Schumer can't control, he's got to follow them. They started saying they're not going to fund anything. And look, they demanded all. I guess the one good thing is they demanded, sorry for the rant, but they demanded all these radical reforms to the Immigrations and Customs Enforcement officers. They didn't get any of them, John. After all of this, this is much like the 43 day shutdown of the entire government last fall, where these guys got nothing when it was over. What was this all about other than just causing pain, you know, and danger for Americans and the people that aren't getting paid? It's just ridiculous.

JOHN:

Representative Tom Emmer, before I let you go, Democrats, you know, they clearly believe, at least for the moment, that they've landed on some sort of winning strategy. And it remains to be seen if that's the case. I'm curious, though, how difficult is it going to be later on this year for Republicans to go and maintain control? I know this is, you know, a big goal of yours. You know, midterm elections, like the ones that we're facing, typically don't do well for the party in power. But I'm just wondering, you know, expectations at the moment for the difficulty that Republicans have in being able to maintain power later this year in the midterms?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, well, first off, anybody who's listening, John, should realize no one's ever lost a midterm in March. I mean, it's the elections next November. And all these media types, not you, but these these talking heads, what do they do? They got to create content. So they do surveys. 500 people here, 750 there, 1200 here. They're little spot checks. They are not reflective of the general population. But then they throw them up on air and say, hey, a poll that we just did today says if you had the election today, you wouldn't win the House. Look, it's going to come down to what it always comes down to, John. The vast majority of Americans right now are just living their lives. If they weren't impacted by this ridiculous shutdown, they're trying to put food on the table, pay the mortgage, make sure that their kids are safe and having a good life. And they just want to go on a vacation. They will wake up sometime after Labor Day. And when they wake up, it'll be an emotional experience in this country, which it always is. And they're going to ask themselves, do I feel better about my economic situation today than I did a year ago? And do I see a bright future, a bright and prosperous future for me and my children? I believe the answer is going to be a resounding yes, because we've already been moving in that direction, despite, again, what these mainstream media outlets and I can't even call the Star Tribune a media outlet. It's a communications arm for the Marxist socialist radical left. But these others that represent themselves as being more mainstream, the issue is we have perception that we aren't there yet. And we've got reality that, you know what, nobody's talking about eggs anymore. And they want to complain about gas

because of the Iran experience. This is the only president that's ever been willing to do something about this in 47 years. But the gas prices are still a couple bucks lower than where they were in the worst times under Joe Biden, John. And once this Iran thing has been completed, which the president is telling us it's going to be in very short order, you will see those gas prices start to tumble down. So I think perception and reality will intersect sometime at the end of the summer, early fall. And that is a great thing because we will hold the house. We'll defy their, their history and their predictions. We're going to hold the Senate and we've got Donald Trump for another two years. So I think the future looks bright.

JOHN:

Representative Tom Emmer. I will take that heading into the weekend. Thank you as always for the time. I look forward to speaking with you again next week.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Happy spring, John. Thanks.

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